

Google to cut AOSP code releases to twice a year from 2026

Starting in 2026, Google will publish Android Open Source Project (AOSP) code only twice a year, down from quarterly releases, according to updates in official AOSP documentation. The new schedule will feature code drops in Q2 and Q4, reflecting Google's plan to align with its "trunk-stable development model" to improve platform stability.

Developers are advised to move from the frequently changing aosp-main branch to android-latest-release, which always points to the most recent stable version. Custom ROM communities, such as LineageOS and GrapheneOS, may experience longer waits for security patches and feature updates, potentially slowing support for older devices.

Device manufacturers will face differing impacts. Top-tier partners, including Samsung, will receive early private access to Android platform code, leaving their development pipelines unaffected. Smaller OEMs and emerging-market manufacturers, reliant on AOSP for cost-effective software without heavy dependence on Google's proprietary services, could struggle to adapt.

The move follows a series of delayed AOSP releases in late 2025, when Android 16 updates reached AOSP weeks after internal rollout. While monthly security updates continue through Android Security Bulletins, their integration into AOSP may not align with the biannual schedule, creating potential vulnerability windows.

Open source advocates expressed concern over reduced transparency. Thom Holwerda, OSNews, commented, "AOSP is already on life support, and with this latest move, Google is firmly gripping the plug."

protocol is compatible with Agent2Agent (A2A), Agent Payments Protocol (AP2), and Model Context Protocol (MCP).

UCP was co-developed with major retail and commerce companies including Shopify, Etsy, Wayfair, Target, and Walmart, signalling broad industry alignment around open agentic commerce standards.

Google plans to deploy UCP initially for select US retailers, with international expansion expected soon. Transactions will use Google Pay and Google Wallet, with PayPal support planned.

MongoDB makes source code of mongot publicly available

MongoDB has released the source code for mongot, the engine powering MongoDB Search and Vector Search, under the Server Side Public License (SSPL). The move gives self-managed users increased visibility, control, and debugging



capabilities, enabling the creation of production-grade retrieval augmented generation (RAG) systems for AI workloads.

"By making mongot's source code publicly available, MongoDB is turning what was previously an Atlas-only...opaque

service into inspectable components, allowing developers to understand how text and vector queries are indexed, executed, and ranked," said Sanjeev Mohan, principal analyst, SanjMo.

While the SSPL allows developers to view, use, modify, and share the code, it is not fully open source. "Like open source licences, the SSPL enables developers to view, use, modify, and share the related source code. It does not meet all the criteria of the Open Source Initiative's open source definition...", said David Menninger, executive director of software research, ISG.

"Rather, the SSPL is 'designed specifically' to stop MongoDB's competitors from taking its free code and selling it as a managed service without paying for it," added Bradley Shimmin, lead, data & analytics practice, The Futurum Group.

Developers now gain access to full search capabilities without relying on Atlas.

"Previously, if a developer wanted the full MongoDB search experience, they had to be on its managed cloud, Atlas. By releasing the source code, MongoDB is effectively removing the functional wall between their cloud service and their self-managed/Community version," said Stephanie Walter, practice lead, AI stack, HyperFRAME Research.

MongoDB has also added automated vector embedding capability to the Community Edition, simplifying RAG pipelines and challenging vector-specialty databases.

Bose turns to open source to keep SoundTouch speakers alive

Bose has open sourced the SoundTouch API documentation for its SoundTouch home theatre smart speakers. The decision comes as SoundTouch Wi-Fi speakers and soundbars are set to lose cloud connectivity and several smart features after February 18, following an announcement made by Bose in October last year. Without cloud services, the devices would otherwise be restricted to basic AUX, HDMI, or Bluetooth connections, significantly reducing their functionality.

By releasing the SoundTouch API documentation, Bose enables developers and advanced users to maintain, extend, or recreate features locally, even after official cloud support is withdrawn. The open source move positions community-